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Course: 21LEM202T - Universal Human Values - II

Unit – 5 : Session – 5 | Holistic Technologies and Production Systems

Part C — Long-Answer Questions (Solutions)

1. Q1. WHY A HOLISTIC WORLDVIEW IS NEEDED for technology, production and management: technology is not neutral in effect — it multiplies the intention of its makers and users. Without a holistic worldview (co-existence, human goal), technology is optimised for profit and power alone, yielding efficient exploitation: attention-harvesting software, planned obsolescence, extraction-oriented production. Production systems designed fragmentarily ('maximise output') externalise costs onto workers, society and nature. Management without the worldview treats humans as resources. Only a holistic view provides the criteria — people-friendly, eco-friendly — by which technology and production can be designed for mutual fulfilment.
2. Q2. FIVE CRITERIA FOR HOLISTIC TECHNOLOGIES: (1) the technology must cater to APPROPRIATE NEED — serve a real, assessed human need, not manufactured want; (2) it must be PEOPLE-FRIENDLY — safe, dignifying, enhancing competence and relationship, not addictive or harmful; (3) it must be ECO-FRIENDLY — cyclical, non-polluting, non-depleting, in harmony with the orders of nature; (4) it must use RENEWABLE/local resources and energy to the extent possible, ensuring continuity; (5) it must be within the COMPETENCE and control of the people who use it — participatory, understandable, maintainable — not creating dependence and centralised domination.
3. Q3. KEY QUESTIONS AND CRITERIA FOR HOLISTIC PRODUCTION SYSTEMS: KEY QUESTIONS — What to produce? (only what is needed for right utilisation) How much? (as per assessed need, not unlimited) How? (by avartansheel processes, in mutual enrichment with nature) For whom? (for mutual fulfilment of all, not for profit concentration). CRITERIA: production must (a) enrich nature while producing (cyclical, waste=food), (b) fulfil real human needs, (c) ensure prosperity in the participating families (fair exchange and storage), (d) strengthen rather than destroy relationship and community, and (e) be sustainable in continuity — able to run forever without depleting or polluting.
4. Q4. EVALUATING ONE PRESENT TECHNOLOGY — the SMARTPHONE PLATFORM (with its app ecosystem): PEOPLE-FRIENDLY? Partially — communication and knowledge access are genuinely fulfilling, but the dominant business model monetises attention through addiction-design (infinite scroll, notification engineering), exploiting the Self's weakness for sensation — failing the people-friendly test in its prevailing form. ECO-FRIENDLY? Partially failing — short replacement cycles, difficult recycling, energy-hungry data centres, mineral extraction with ecological and human cost. USER-FRIENDLY/competence? The device is usable but not maintainable or understandable by the user — sealed, dependence-creating. VERDICT with the holistic lens: the technology itself is valuable; the ASSUMPTION behind its design (engagement = profit) is what must change — the same capability, designed for right utilisation and mutual fulfilment, would pass all five criteria.